

IELTS Writing: Fake Tips Debunked

Book 13 · Ignore viral advice that quietly lowers your score

Stratum IELTS · stratumielts.com

Edition 2026 · Original content

Part of the Stratum IELTS Writing Guide Series

Who this book is for

YouTube is full of “Band 9 secrets”.
Some help. Many sound clever and **hurt Task Response, Lexis, or tone**.
This book separates useful habits from noisy myths.

Contents

- 1. How to judge any tip
- 2. Myth vs reality table
- 3. What to do instead
- 4. Cleanup checklist for your next essay
- 5. Next step

1. How to judge any tip

Ask three questions:

- 1. Does this help me answer the exact question?
- 2. Can I control this language under time pressure?
- 3. Does it sound natural in academic writing?

If any answer is no, drop the tip.

2. Myth vs reality

Viral tip	Reality	Better approach
Use as many idioms as possible	Idioms often sound informal/forced	Prefer clear academic phrasing

Never repeat any word	Unnatural; topic words can repeat	Repeat key topic nouns; vary verbs/adjectives lightly
Write 350+ words always	More length ≠ higher band; more errors risk	Aim 260–300 with clear development
Invent statistics for examples	Looks fake and risky	Use realistic scenarios, not fake surveys
Rare vocabulary = Band 7	Wrong rare words lower score	Accurate common academic words
Memorise full templates	Examiners spot generic scripts	Flexible paragraph jobs (Book 8)
Linking words in every sentence	Mechanical cohesion	Link only when logic needs it
Range matters more than accuracy	Frequent error-free sentences matter	Complex grammar only if controlled
Hook in every introduction	Wastes time; often off-task	Paraphrase + direct answer
Always 3 body paragraphs	Not required; often shallow	Two developed bodies are enough

3. What to do instead (practical)

Examples

Bad: *According to a 2024 global survey, 83.4% of teenagers...*

Good: *For example, many teenagers check social apps during study sessions and lose focus.*

Vocabulary

Bad: *The multifaceted ramifications of this paradigm...*

Good: *This change has several important effects on workers.*

Length

Write enough to develop two ideas. Stop when the job is done. Edit for 5 minutes.

Cohesion

One clear topic sentence beats five empty linkers.

4. Cleanup checklist

Before submit:

- ☐ No fake statistics

- ☐ No idiom stuffing
- ☐ No memorised hook unrelated to the question
- ☐ Linking words are not every sentence
- ☐ Word count is enough, not inflated
- ☐ Rare words are only ones I can use correctly

Then check at <https://stratumielts.com>.

5. Next step

- Template addiction → **Book 8**
- Plateau after myths removed → **Book 6**
- Idea panic → **Book 7**

Stratum rule: clear answer + controlled language beats viral tricks.

Published by **Stratum IELTS** · stratumielts.com · Edition 2026
End of Book 13 — Fake Tips Debunked